YAML

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National Policy for the Promotion of Smart Health Services and Artificial Intelligence in the UAE Health Sector

Issued Date: 18 May 2026
Lead Entity: Ministry of Health and Prevention
Sector: Healthcare

Introduction

The UAE seeks to consolidate its position as a global leader in the digital and artificial intelligence fields through national initiatives aimed at strengthening its global competitiveness and establishing the country as a hub for artificial intelligence applications and digital services. This will be achieved by developing a smart ecosystem that enables productivity and innovation, investing in people and priority sectors across vital fields, and ensuring effective governance, enabling infrastructure, and appropriate regulatory frameworks.

In this context, the healthcare sector is undergoing a profound transformation driven by rapid advances in artificial intelligence technologies, which have become a major force in reshaping the future of healthcare and improving quality of life. Guided by its forward-looking vision, the UAE continues to strengthen its position among the leading countries investing in digital health and artificial intelligence, thereby supporting the provision of advanced and sustainable healthcare services for all members of society.

Smart health and artificial intelligence are key pillars and strategic pathways for advancing the healthcare system and its services. The UAE is committed to providing the community with high-quality healthcare services in line with international best practices, while

strengthening its global leadership in this field and advancing its vision for the responsible use of artificial intelligence across the healthcare sector.

These efforts align with the UAE Artificial Intelligence Strategy and its contribution to the objectives of the UAE Centennial 2071. They support the development of a proactive, human-centred, agile, and technologically advanced healthcare system in which artificial intelligence serves as a national pathway to improve quality of life, strengthen health security, and establish the UAE as a global reference for health innovation and comprehensive future care.

Healthcare is among the sectors with the greatest potential to benefit from artificial intelligence. Its applications can play a pivotal role in improving the efficiency, quality, and safety of evidence-based preventive, therapeutic, rehabilitative, and administrative healthcare services, while expanding access to care and improving research outcomes.

Smart health refers to the purposeful and effective use of digital technologies to promote health and well-being at both individual and community levels. Artificial intelligence is a key enabling technology within the smart health ecosystem. Artificial intelligence in healthcare refers to the use of computer systems and algorithms, including machine learning, deep learning, and natural language processing, that learn from health and medical data to perform tasks such as diagnosis, prediction, treatment planning, rehabilitation, and healthcare system improvement.

Accordingly, the UAE continues to promote integration between people and technology by supporting national talent and equipping the workforce with the required knowledge and tools. In parallel, it is expanding the scope and role of artificial intelligence applications and improving the efficiency of smart healthcare processes and services to enhance the health and quality of life of the community on a sustainable basis.

This policy provides a multisectoral national framework to coordinate and guide these efforts towards the following goal: **“A smart, integrated, proactive, and sustainable national health system that uses artificial intelligence to improve the health of the UAE community”.**

Policy Objectives

1. Strengthen governance and leadership to ensure the effective and integrated facilitation and regulation of smart health and artificial intelligence applications across the healthcare sector.
2. Improve the quality, efficiency, and sustainability of the healthcare system by developing secure and advanced digital infrastructure that improves access to smart health services for all members of society.

3. Promote a proactive approach to healthcare by using smart technologies in prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and rehabilitation, thereby helping to reduce disease and address health challenges.
4. Foster innovation and support scientific research in smart health and artificial intelligence to advance the development of advanced and sustainable healthcare solutions.
5. Develop human capital and build capacity by qualifying healthcare professionals and investing in a workforce proficient in smart health and artificial intelligence technologies.
6. Strengthen public trust by protecting health data and complying with the highest ethical and regulatory standards in smart health and artificial intelligence applications.
7. Establish the UAE as a global hub for smart health and artificial intelligence in the healthcare sector.

Priorities and Key Components

1. Strengthening governance and leadership

- Building institutional, societal, and financial commitment to the UAE's direction for enabling smart health services.
- Developing health legislation that supports the adoption of smart solutions and artificial intelligence across the healthcare sector.
- Developing a mechanism for the effective use of artificial intelligence in the design, development, and implementation of health policies and legislation.

2. Building partnerships at all levels and achieving integration

- Strengthening coordination through national partnerships.
- Promoting community engagement, communication, and awareness.
- Strengthening effective partnerships, networks, and international cooperation to facilitate the exchange of knowledge and expertise.

3. Expanding and diversifying digital and AI technologies

- Managing health systems and operations and enabling intelligent analysis.
- Delivering direct clinical care, including diagnosis, treatment, rehabilitation, and precision and personalized medicine.
- Enhancing the capabilities of telemedicine services.

- Improving quality of life through smart preventive healthcare.
- Strengthening disease and health-risk prediction and supporting strategic foresight.

4. Developing infrastructure for smart health and AI

- Advancing digital transformation across all healthcare facilities and ensuring the sustainability of smart digital infrastructure.
- Ensuring the quality and efficiency of smart health services and artificial intelligence solutions, including generative artificial intelligence applications.

5. Empowering national talent with digital skills

- Strengthening education in smart health and supporting academic qualifications.
- Building an institutional digital culture.
- Providing continuing professional training and development.

6. Ensuring the security and ethics of smart health services

- Strengthening an integrated cybersecurity system for the healthcare sector.
- Raising security awareness and building users' capabilities.

7. Ensuring the ethical use of smart health services and AI

- Establishing and promoting ethical principles for the use of smart health services and artificial intelligence across the healthcare sector to strengthen trust and digital stability.
- Establishing clear medical liability frameworks for the delivery of smart health services and the use of artificial intelligence applications across the healthcare sector.

8. Strengthening innovation, research capabilities, and information systems

- Strengthening the smart health innovation system.
- Supporting research capabilities in digital health and artificial intelligence.
- Strengthening health information technology systems.

Expected Outcomes

1. Developing and promoting the digital health infrastructure to support the use of smart health technologies and artificial intelligence.

2. Increasing the number of healthcare institutions that adopt smart health applications and artificial intelligence systems in diagnosis, treatment, rehabilitation, and healthcare service management.
3. Increasing the number of artificial intelligence-enabled health solutions and applications developed or deployed in healthcare sector facilities.
4. Increasing the number of research initiatives and innovative projects in smart health and artificial intelligence in healthcare.
5. Increasing the number of qualified healthcare professionals in artificial intelligence.
6. Increasing national and international partnerships for the development of smart health technologies.
7. Expanding the use of digital health services in prevention, diagnosis, treatment and rehabilitation, including telemedicine services and smart health applications.

Target Audience

The UAE community, the UAE’ s public healthcare sector and authorities, medical associations, the private healthcare sector, and other relevant health entities, as well as non-health-related stakeholders, and the academic and research institutions in the UAE.

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